Yunfei (Jesse) Yao

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Web: www.jesseyao.com

CURRENT POSITION

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Associate Professor of Business Administration, 2026 – present
Assistant Professor of Business Administration, 2023 – 2026

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley, Ph.D. Business Administration, 2023
Stanford University, Exchange student in Economics, 2019
University of Michigan, B.S. Mathematics, B.S. Statistics, 2017
Peking University, Major in Mathematics, 2012 - 2015

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Strategic considerations of AI/ML, privacy, search, information economics

PUBLICATIONS (P: Ph.D. or pre-doc student, a: assistant professor, at the time of project initiation)

8. **Invitation to Search or Purchase? Optimal Multi-attribute Advertising** ***Management Science****, forthcoming*
Yunfei (Jesse) Yao

7. **Strategic Disinformation Generation and Detection** ***Management Science****, forthcoming*
Wenxiao Yang P*, Yunfei (Jesse) Yao, and Pengxiang Zhou* P

6. **Algorithmic Targeting and the Precision-Recall Trade-off** ***Marketing Science****,* 2026, 45(4), 844-863.
Ganesh Iyer, Yunfei (Jesse) Yao, and Zemin (Zachary) Zhong a

5. **Privacy and Polarization: An Inference-Based Framework** ***Management Science****,* 2026, 72(2), 1389-1409.
Tommaso Bondi a*, Omid Rafieian* a*, and Yunfei (Jesse) Yao*
Extended Abstract at EC'24 *(25th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation)*

4. **Reputation for Privacy** ***Marketing Science****,* 2025, 44(5), 1145-1162.
Yunfei (Jesse) Yao

3. **Search Fatigue, Choice Deferral, and Closure** ***Marketing Science****,* 2025, 44(5), 1188-1211.
Z. Eddie Ning a*, J. Miguel Villas-Boas, and Yunfei (Jesse) Yao*

2. **Dynamic Persuasion and Strategic Search** ***Management Science****,* 2024, 70(10), 6778-6803.
Yunfei (Jesse) Yao
Finalist, Frank M. Bass Dissertation Paper Award

1. **A Dynamic Model of Optimal Retargeting** ***Marketing Science****,* 2021, 40(3), 428-458.
J. Miguel Villas-Boas, and Yunfei (Jesse) Yao

WORKING PAPERS

◦ **A Consumer Search Explanation for Hidden Fees** (with *Samir Mamadehussene* a and *Jingbo Wang* a)

◦ **Non-stationary Pricing and Search** (with *Wee Chaimanowong* P)

TEACHING

◦ Instructor, Digital Marketing (MS), 2023 - present

Teaching Evaluation: 2023: 5.9/6, 5.8/6 (adjusted mean/total)

2024: 5.9/6, 5.9/6, 5.9/6

2025: 6.0/6, 5.9/6, 5.9/6

◦ Graduate Student Instructor (2019 - 2023):

Game Theory (MBA), Marketing Strategy (MBA), Microeconomic Theory I, II (PhD), Marketing (UG)

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

SAP America, Development Intern (advertising attribution group), May 2018 – Dec. 2018

SEMINAR TALKS

University of Pennsylvania	2026
University of Michigan	
University of Southern California	
University of Maryland	
Yale University	
University College London	
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology	2025
City University of Hong Kong	
Berkeley Economics Theory Lunch	
Berkeley Economics Theory Lunch	2023
Peking University	2022
Nova School of Business and Economics	
University of Melbourne	
University of Texas at Dallas	
University of Rochester	
Hong Kong University of Science and Technology	
The Chinese University of Hong Kong	
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	
University of California, Berkeley	
Berkeley Economics Theory Lunch *2	

CONFERENCE TALKS

Asia-Pacific Industrial Organization Conference (APIOC)	2026
SICS – 24th Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy (discussant)	
48th INFORMS Marketing Science Conference (session chair)	
Hong Kong Quant Marketing Brown Bag Series	
China Marketing 50 Forum at SJTU (AI & Marketing)	
Marketing Theory Seminar Series	2025
2025 China India Insights Conference	
SICS – 23rd Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy	
14th Workshop on Search and Switching Costs (discussant)	
3rd Asia-Pacific Marketing Academy Conference	
NYU Shanghai Research Workshop	
Hong Kong Quant Marketing Brown Bag Series	

19th Annual Bass FORMS Conference (discussant)

SICS – 22nd Summer Institute in Competitive Strategy 2024
46th INFORMS Marketing Science Conference
Hong Kong Quant Marketing Mini Conference
Hong Kong Quant Marketing Brown Bag Series
18th Annual Bass FORMS Conference
CUHK and CUHK-SZ Joint Marketing Workshop

ISMS Marketing Science Conference 2023
Bay Area Marketing Symposium
17th Annual Bass FORMS Conference (discussant)

Berkeley/Columbia/Duke/MIT/Northwestern IO Theory Conference 2022
(one of four *Journal of Industrial Economics fellows*)

HONORS AND AWARDS

- Finalist, Frank M. Bass Dissertation Paper Award, 2026
- Young Researcher Award, 2025 (HK$ 100,000, sole recipient in the business school)

SERVICE

To the field:

Associate Editor:
Management Science

Editorial Review Board Member:
Marketing Science

Reviewer:
Management Science,
- 2025 *Management Science* Meritorious Service Award

Marketing Science,
Journal of Marketing Research,
RAND Journal of Economics,
Production and Operations Management,
Quantitative Marketing and Economics,
Review of Industrial Organization,
HICSS

To the university:

Business Administration Panel of Research Committee, 2026 – present
Academic Advisor for IBBA Students, 2023 – present
JUPAS IBBA (undergraduate) program interviewing panelist, 2024, 2025, 2026
Sessions with Visiting Committee, 2025

To the department:

Executive Committee, 2025 – present
Inter-departmental Research Workshop Coordinator, 2026 - present

Seminar coordinator, 2024 – 2026
Doctoral program interviews, 2023
Faculty recruiting interviews, 2023

ADVISING

◦ Wee Chaimanowong, Ph.D. co-author and letter writer
◦ Wenxiao Yang, Ph.D. co-author
◦ Pengxiang Zhou, pre-doc co-author and letter writer, placed at the University of Southern California (Ph.D.)
◦ Yachong Wang, first-year paper advisor
◦ Teng Yu, Independent Research supervisor